

Research Methods

Day 14 · Session 14: Final Preparations, Reflection & Camp Review

July 16, 2026

Outline for Today

1. **Final Polish Time**
2. **Camp Review & Synthesis Discussion**
3. **Camp Review Mission Sheet**
4. **Letter to Future Nexellence INQUIRE Students**
5. **Scientific Storytelling: Opening Line Practice**



Session 14: Final Preparations, Reflection & Camp Review

Learning Objectives

Polish presentations to final presentation quality

Last changes, final checks — everything Summit-ready.

Reflect on learning and growth across three weeks

Name what you know now that you didn't when you started.

Understand and celebrate the full research process

See the whole arc — question to Summit — that you completed.

Prepare for the Research Summit audience

Parents, guests, and instructors — ready your hook and your poise.



Morning: ResearchCORE



Final Polish Time

Final Polish Time (45 min)

Make any **remaining changes** to your slides — then stop tinkering.

While you polish, the instructor does a **final review** of each team's:



References slide — every cited source listed.



AI Attribution Statement — present and accurate.



Citation format — consistent throughout.



Know when to stop

At some point, more edits add risk, not polish.

When the checklist is green, close the laptop and rehearse instead.

45:00



Camp Review & Synthesis Discussion

Camp Review & Synthesis (30 min)

An instructor-led discussion. One prompt:

What are the five most important things you know about research that you *didn't* know three weeks ago?

Each student contributes **one idea**. We capture them all on the whiteboard under one heading:

"What Nexellence INQUIRE taught us"

💡 **Think across the whole arc**

From a first curious question, to methods, to data, to a story you can defend — what shifted in how you *think*, not just what you can do?

30:00

Session 14 Mission Sheet: Camp Review (30 min)

Complete four reflections — your record of the journey:

- 1 **One thing that went well** in your rehearsal.
- 2 Something **interesting you learned from another team**.
- 3 What you're **most proud of**.
- 4 A **new research question** you'd love to explore in the future.

 That last one matters most: the best sign of a real researcher is leaving with **more** questions than you arrived with.

30:00



Letter to Future Nexellence INQUIRE Students

Letter to a Future Student (30 min)

Write a **one-page letter** — or record a voice note or video — to a future Nexellence INQUIRE student.

Speak to them honestly:

- What **advice** would you give?
- What **surprised** you along the way?
- What would you tell your **past self** before starting?

 **Your words will outlast you here**

These letters are archived — future students really will read them. Write the thing you *wish* someone had told you on day one.

30:00



Scientific Storytelling: Opening Line Practice

Your First 30 Seconds

Each presenter rehearses their **opening line** and first-slide intro **one final time**.

🚫 **The one rule:** no one starts with *"Hi, my name is..."*

Open with a **hook** instead:

- a **surprising statistic**
- a **compelling question**
- a **striking image**

📌 The first 30 seconds sets the tone

An audience decides whether to lean in almost immediately. Earn their attention before you spend it on introductions.

"Every year, teenagers lose two full weeks of sleep to their phones. We wanted to know what that costs them..."

15:00

Session 14: What You Can Do Now

Final polish:

- Bring your slides, **References**, and **AI attribution** to final, consistent, Summit quality — and recognize when to stop editing and start rehearsing.

Reflection & growth:

- Articulate the **five biggest things** you learned about research, complete your Camp Review reflections, and write a letter that passes what you learned to the next cohort.

Summit readiness:

- Open with a **hook**, not "Hi, my name is" — a stat, a question, or an image that earns the room's attention in the first 30 seconds.